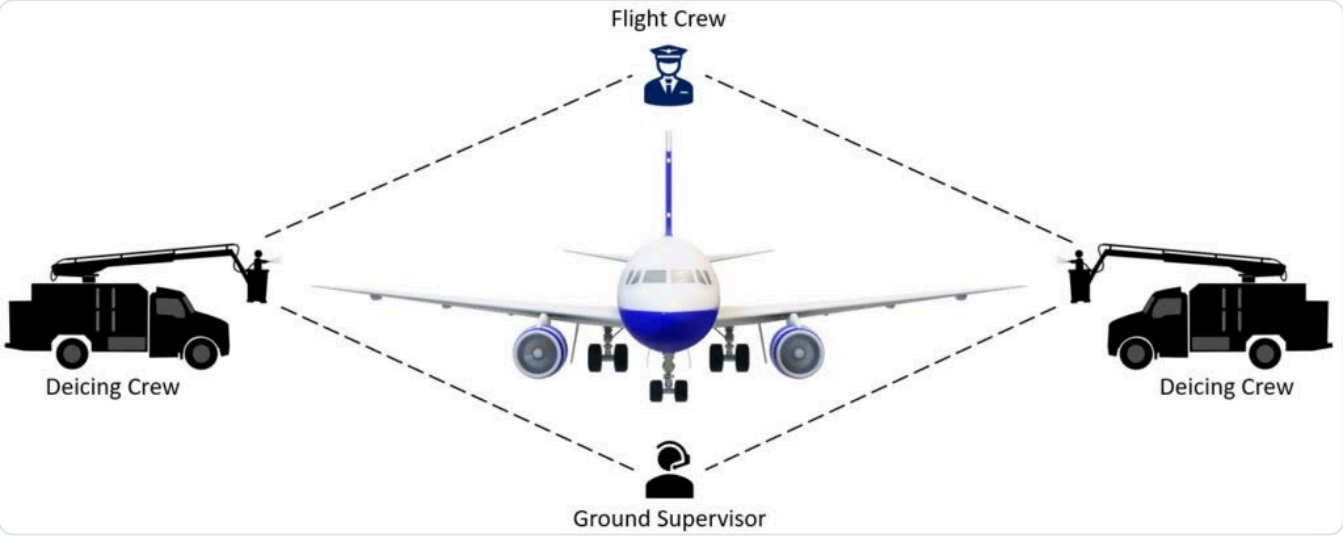
MODULE 2 · DE-ICING AND ANTI-ICING

Lesson 10: Communication with the De-icing Crew and the Anti-icing Code

Lesson 10 of 30 · about 8 min

LEARNING OBJECTIVES

- Use a structured communication sequence before, during and after treatment.
- Read and record the anti-icing code.
- Apply closed-loop communication under time pressure.



Everyone involved in the treatment — flight crew, de-icing crews and supervisor — must share one communication plan.

Why communication matters

The flight crew cannot see most of what happens during de-icing. The de-icing crew cannot see inside the flight deck. Several accidents and serious incidents happened because one side assumed what the other was doing — engines moved while people were near the aircraft, or an aircraft taxied with parts of it untreated. Communication must follow a standard sequence and use closed-loop read-back.

Before treatment

- Establish contact on the agreed radio frequency or interphone.
- The crew confirms the aircraft is configured for de-icing and the brakes are set.
- Agree the treatment: de-icing only, one-step or two-step, fluid type and concentration, and the areas to treat.
- Make a PA to the passengers (and inform cabin crew) that de-icing is about to begin; they will hear noise and may smell fluid.

After treatment — the anti-icing code

When treatment and the post-treatment check are complete, the de-icing crew passes the **anti-icing code**. The SAE AS6285 format contains:

1. Fluid type (I, II, III or IV);
2. Concentration, as fluid/water percentage (not needed for Type I);
3. Local time at the **beginning** of the final application;
4. Date (written record);
5. The statement “post de-icing/anti-icing check completed”.

Where a brand name is known, it may also be given so you can use brand-specific tables.

De-icing crew: “Domestic 247, treatment complete. Anti-icing code: Type four, one hundred percent, start time one four three five, post de-icing anti-icing check completed.”

Flight crew: “Type four, one hundred, one four three five, check completed — Domestic 247.”

De-icing crew: “All personnel and equipment clear. Contact ground on one two one decimal niner.”

Flight crew: “Clear, ground one two one decimal niner, Domestic 247.”

Example only — use the phraseology in the Operations Manual and the local de-icing procedures.

Using the code

- Read the code back in full. Write it on the flight log or enter it as the company procedure requires.
- Calculate the HOT using the fluid, concentration and current conditions, and brief the end time.
- Do not move the aircraft, start engines or change configuration until the "all clear" call.

UNDER TIME PRESSURE

De-icing usually happens at the busiest moment of a winter departure. Slow down: use standard phrases, read back every number, and ask again if anything is unclear. Thirty seconds of clarification is cheaper than a return to the pad — or an accident.

KEY TAKEAWAYS

- Confirm configuration, brakes set and the treatment plan before spraying starts.
- Anti-icing code: fluid type, concentration, start time of final step, date, check completed.
- Read back the code and calculate HOT from the start time of the final application.
- Do not move until the de-icing crew calls “all personnel and equipment clear”.

KNOWLEDGE CHECK

Which time in the anti-icing code do you use to calculate holdover time?

A. The time the de-icing truck arrived

B. The time treatment finished

C. The local time at the beginning of the final application

D. The time you received the code

Answer: C. The anti-icing code gives the local start time of the final application, which is when holdover time begins.

Training material only. It does not replace the Aircraft Flight Manual, FCOM, QRH, MEL or the Domestic Airlines Operations Manual, which always take precedence.